

GOVERNMENT HACK™

Unit Assessment Book

Unit 2 — Citizen Participation · Teacher Edition

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Three parts: (1) Formative Checkpoints — a short check per standard for progress monitoring (MTSS); (2) Unit Summative — two parallel forms (A and B) for pre/post or retakes; (3) Teacher Answer Key + Item Analysis + Reteach.

All items are pulled from the Government Hack question bank. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Administering these forms is what generates the response data to CALIBRATE the pre-calibrated items — the first cycle of use closes the loop.

Keys and reteach live in this teacher book only — reproduce the student sections (formative + Form A/B) without the key section.

Contents

Part 1 — Formative Checkpoints (by standard)

A quick DOK-balanced check for each standard. Use for progress monitoring; reteach routing is in the Teacher Key.

GC.31 — The Responsibilities of Citizens

1. Which of the following is a legal duty required of U.S. citizens, not merely encouraged? [GC.31 · DOK 1 · pre-field-test]

- A. Serving on a jury when summoned
- B. Volunteering for a local charity
- C. Following the news on civic issues
- D. Campaigning for a candidate you support

GC.32 — Political Parties & the Nomination Process

1. What is the main difference between a primary and a caucus in choosing a party's nominee? [GC.32 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. A primary is held only in general elections; a caucus only for judges
- B. A primary uses a secret ballot; a caucus uses local meetings and debate
- C. A primary is run by the government; a caucus is illegal in most states
- D. A primary picks a president; a caucus picks a governor

GC.33 — The Media & Public Opinion

1. How can the wording of a public-opinion poll question affect the results it produces? [GC.33 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. Wording cannot change results because opinions are fixed before the poll
- B. Only the number of people surveyed affects results, never the wording
- C. Leading or loaded wording can push respondents toward a particular answer
- D. Poll results are always accurate no matter how questions are worded

GC.34 — Means of Political Participation

1. Which First Amendment protections most directly allow citizens to march in a protest and sign a petition? [GC.34 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. The rights to bear arms and to a jury trial
- B. The rights to due process and equal protection
- C. The rights against self-incrimination and unreasonable search
- D. The rights to peaceably assemble and to petition the government

Part 2 — Unit Summative · Form A

DIRECTIONS

Choose the best answer for each question. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

1. Thomas Jefferson wrote that 'wherever the people are well informed they can be trusted with their own government.' Which civic responsibility does this statement most directly support? [GC.31 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. Paying federal income taxes on time
- B. Serving in the armed forces when called
- C. Staying informed on civic issues
- D. Obeying local traffic laws

2. In the presidential nomination process, what is the purpose of the primaries and caucuses held state by state? [GC.32 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. To choose each party's nominee before the general election
- B. To count the electoral votes after the general election
- C. To confirm the President's cabinet appointments
- D. To redraw congressional district boundaries

3. A news outlet covers one issue heavily every night for a week while barely mentioning others. How does this most likely influence the public? [GC.33 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. It guarantees the public will oppose the government entirely
- B. It has no effect, since the public ignores repeated stories
- C. It forces rival outlets to drop the issue completely
- D. It makes the issue seem more important than others

4. Which action gives citizens a way to directly propose or overturn a law themselves, rather than only influencing officials? [GC.34 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. Campaigning for a candidate who supports the law
- B. Using an initiative or referendum
- C. Lobbying a legislator to sponsor a bill
- D. Writing a letter to a representative

Part 3 — Unit Summative · Form B

DIRECTIONS

Choose the best answer for each question. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

1. A citizen who is called for jury service is fulfilling a responsibility that is best described as: [GC.31 · DOK 1 · pre-field-test]

- A. entirely optional for everyone
- B. required only of public officials
- C. limited to voters over age 35
- D. a legal duty the courts enforce

2. George Washington warned against 'the spirit of party,' yet political parties quickly became central to elections. What role do parties play in the political system? [GC.32 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. They write the amendments to the U.S. Constitution
- B. They serve as the nation's court system
- C. They organize voters and nominate candidates for office
- D. They command the national armed forces

3. Two newspapers report the same city council vote. One headline reads 'Council Protects Taxpayers'; the other reads 'Council Cuts Vital Services.' What does this best illustrate? [GC.33 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. Media framing can shape how the public feels about the same event
- B. One newspaper reported false information about the vote
- C. The city council changed its decision between the reports
- D. Headlines have no measurable effect on public opinion

4. A citizen meets with a state legislator to try to persuade the legislator to support a new bill. This form of participation is called: [GC.34 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. petitioning
- B. lobbying
- C. demonstrating
- D. running for office

Part 4 — Teacher Answer Key + Item Analysis + Reteach

READING THE ANALYSIS

Each item shows its standard, DOK, correct key, and TCAP reporting category, plus a reteach move. Distractor-based routing: a wrong choice signals which idea to reteach — pair with the workbook Cornell notes and Guided Support. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Form A — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.31	2	C	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit The Responsibilities of Citizens — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.32	2	A	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit Political Parties & the Nomination Process — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.33	3	D	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit The Media & Public Opinion — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
4	GC.34	3	B	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit Means of Political Participation — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Form B — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.31	1	D	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit The Responsibilities of Citizens — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.32	2	C	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit Political Parties & the Nomination Process — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.33	3	A	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit The Media & Public Opinion — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
4	GC.34	2	B	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit Means of Political Participation — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Formative Checkpoints — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.31	1	A	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit The Responsibilities of Citizens — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.32	2	B	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit Political Parties & the Nomination Process — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
3	GC.33	3	C	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit The Media & Public Opinion — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
4	GC.34	2	D	RC-GOV2: Citizen Participation	Revisit Means of Political Participation — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Part 5 — Psychometric Blueprint (Teacher)

ABOUT THESE NUMBERS

Every item carries a cognitive-rigor classification (Webb's DOK × Bloom's, located on the Hess Cognitive Rigor Matrix) and a pre-calibration IRT 3PL estimate: a = discrimination, b = difficulty, c = pseudo-guessing.

These IRT parameters are DESIGN-TIME ESTIMATES, not empirical calibrations. IRT 3PL parameters are pre-field-test design-time estimates, to be calibrated on field-test data. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Distractor codes: PK prior-knowledge · MC misconception · PE partial evidence · NE nearby error · CA causal attribution · AN anachronism · OG overgeneralization.

BANK DISTRIBUTION

DOK: 1: 2 · 2: 6 · 3: 4

Bloom's: Remember: 2 · Understand: 5 · Analyze: 4 · Apply: 1

Mean discrimination a ≈ 1.417 · Mean difficulty b ≈ -0.017

Field-test-ready items: 12 of 12

Form A — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.31	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.5	0.1	0.2	D3	Y	A:PE B:PE D:PE
2	GC.32	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.4	-0.1	0.2	D2	Y	B:PK C:PK D:PK
3	GC.33	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.6	0.6	0.2	D3	Y	A:OG B:MC C:CA
4	GC.34	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.7	0.7	0.2	D2	Y	A:NE C:NE D:NE

Form B — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.31	1	Remember × DOK 1	1.2	-0.9	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC B:MC C:MC
2	GC.32	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.4	-0.2	0.2	D2	Y	A:PK B:PK D:PK
3	GC.33	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.6	0.5	0.2	D3	Y	B:CA C:MC D:MC
4	GC.34	2	Apply × DOK 2	1.3	-0.1	0.2	D2	Y	A:NE C:NE D:NE

Formative — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.31	1	Remember × DOK 1	1.1	-1.1	0.2	D2	Y	B:PE C:PE D:MC
2	GC.32	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.3	-0.2	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC C:MC D:PK

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
3	GC.33	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.5	0.5	0.2	D3	Y	A:MC B:PE D:MC
4	GC.34	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.4	0	0.2	D2	Y	A:PK B:PK C:PK

Part 6 — UDL Supports & Remediation (Teacher)

UNIVERSAL DESIGN FOR LEARNING (UDL 3.0) SUPPORTS — APPLIES TO EVERY ITEM

These supports vary the MEANS of access, not the mastery target. They apply to every item on the formative checkpoints and both summative forms.

Representation — CAST 3.0 Rep — key terms glossed (EN/ES); read-aloud on request; large-print/screen-reader friendly

Action & Expression — [MC] respond by selecting/pointing/AT · [open] respond in writing, speech, or a labeled diagram; word processor/speech-to-text available

Engagement — action-oriented feedback via the remediation routing; DOK-tiered challenge

Supports vary the means, not the mastery target — UDL design, not modification. CAST (2024). Universal Design for Learning Guidelines version 3.0.

HOW TO USE THIS SECTION

For each item: if a student misses it, start with the If-missed reteach, then route by the SPECIFIC wrong choice the student picked (each distractor signals a distinct misconception), and escalate through MTSS Tier 2 → Tier 3 if the misconception persists across parallel forms. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Form A — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.31 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “The Responsibilities of Citizens” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Partial evidence — a real duty, but not the one Jefferson's statement addresses.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion
B	Partial evidence — a valid responsibility unrelated to being informed.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion
D	Partial evidence — a legal duty, but not what the quotation supports.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.32 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Political Parties & the Nomination Process” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Prior-knowledge error confusing nomination with the Electoral College count.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
C	Prior-knowledge error confusing nomination with Senate confirmation.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Prior-knowledge error confusing elections with redistricting.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.33 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “The Media & Public Opinion” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Overgeneralization — coverage does not dictate a single public reaction.	test the overgeneralization against a counter-case
B	Misconception that repeated coverage has no agenda-setting effect.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Causal attribution error — one outlet's focus does not control competitors.	re-teach the cause-effect chain

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 4 — GC.34 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “Means of Political Participation” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Nearby error — a real form of participation, but it influences officials rather than making law directly.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Nearby error — lobbying pressures officials rather than letting voters act directly.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
D	Nearby error — contacting a representative is indirect influence, not direct lawmaking.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer

MTSS ROUTING

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item. Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.		

Form B — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.31 · DOK 1

If missed: Revisit “The Responsibilities of Citizens” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Misconception that jury service is optional.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
B	Misconception that the duty applies only to officials.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Misconception adding an age limit that does not define the duty.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.32 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Political Parties & the Nomination Process” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Prior-knowledge error confusing parties with the Article V amendment process.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
B	Prior-knowledge error confusing parties with the judicial branch.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Prior-knowledge error confusing parties with the executive military role.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.33 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “The Media & Public Opinion” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Causal attribution error — different framing is not the same as false reporting.	re-teach the cause-effect chain
C	Misconception that differing headlines mean the underlying event changed.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
D	Misconception that framing has no effect on opinion.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 4 — GC.34 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Means of Political Participation” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Nearby error — petitioning is a written request signed by many, not a one-on-one persuasion meeting.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Nearby error — demonstrating is public protest, not private persuasion of an official.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
D	Nearby error — running for office is seeking a seat, not persuading a sitting legislator.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Formative Checkpoints — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.31 · DOK 1

If missed: Revisit “The Responsibilities of Citizens” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Plausible error — volunteering is expected of good citizens but is not legally required.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion
C	Plausible error — staying informed is encouraged, not legally compelled.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion
D	Misconception that civic activity such as campaigning is a legal obligation.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.32 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Political Parties & the Nomination Process” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Misconception about when and for whom each method is used.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Misconception that caucuses are illegal or that primaries are government-run rather than party contests.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
D	Prior-knowledge error confusing the office chosen rather than the method used.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.33 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “The Media & Public Opinion” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Misconception that public opinion is fixed and unaffected by measurement.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
B	Partial evidence — sample size matters, but wording is overlooked.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion
D	Misconception that polls are objective regardless of question design.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item. Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.		

Item 4 — GC.34 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Means of Political Participation” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Prior-knowledge error citing Second and Sixth Amendment rights.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
B	Prior-knowledge error citing Fourteenth Amendment protections.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
C	Prior-knowledge error citing Fifth and Fourth Amendment rights.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.